

Seawall height in Golden Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

GOLDEN BEACH • MIAMI-DADE COUNTY

4.425

ft NAVD88 (single required value: "constructed at an elevation of"; not labelled minimum or maximum)

All new and replacement seawalls must be built to 4.425 ft NAVD88. Existing legal nonconforming seawalls must be brought up when the home is substantially improved or demolished, the wall is materially altered, or the property is sold.

The detail

REQUIRED HEIGHT	All new and replacement seawalls shall be constructed at an elevation of 4.425 ft NAVD-88 - Golden Beach Code Sec. 46-85(a)
DOCKS	Min 3.425 ft, max 4.425 ft NAVD-88; finish material max 3 in. thick - Sec. 46-85(a)
NONCONFORMING WALLS	Must comply on >50% improvement, demolition of primary structure, or material alteration - Sec. 46-86(b)
SALE	Pre-sale engineer report must state cap height in NAVD-88; deficiencies, including raising the cap if not per NAVD-88 requirements, must be corrected and a building permit application submitted within 180 days after closing - Sec. 46-86(b)(5)
SURVEYS	Permit and as-built surveys show cap elevations in NAVD-88 at 20-ft intervals - Sec. 46-79

Where this comes from: Golden Beach Code of Ordinances Sec. 46-85(a)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1

Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2

Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.